Meitnerium

109 **Mt** Named in honor of the Austrian physicist Lise Meitner, meitnerium was first created in Germany in 1982, when atoms of bismuth and iron were smashed into one another. This radioactive element has no known uses outside research.

Meitner and Hahn

The German chemist Otto Hahn singly won the Nobel Prize in Chemistry in 1944 for his and Meitner's work on nuclear fission. Meitner went on to have a new element named after her.

Otto Hahn (left) and Lise Meitner

Darmstadtium

110 **Ds** First created in 1994 in the German city of Darmstadt, darmstadtium was later named after this city. Only a few atoms of this highly radioactive element have ever been made. Little is known about this element, but it's expected to be similar to palladium and platinum.

Sigurd Hofmann

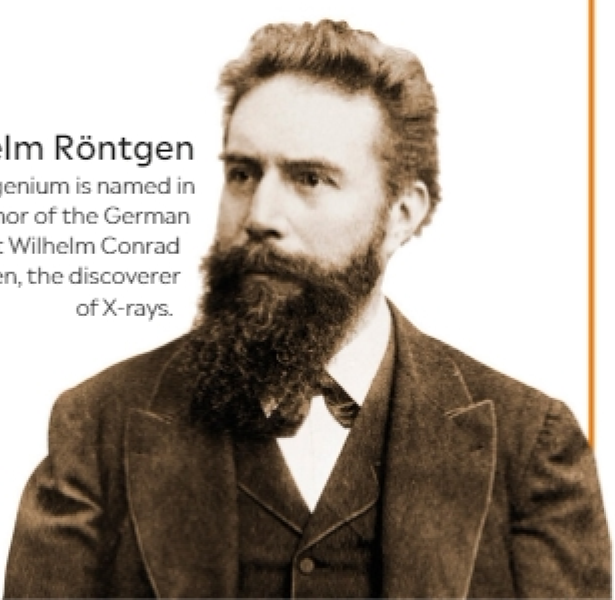
A team led by the German physicist Sigurd Hofmann first created darmstadtium by smashing nickel and lead atoms into one another. Hofmann also worked on the creation of two other artificial elements—roentgenium and copernicium.

Roentgenium

111 **Rg** As this element is placed directly below gold on the periodic table, some scientists believe it is likely to share some of gold's characteristics. It was first made in 1994 by smashing together nickel and bismuth atoms. It was informally known as E111 before being officially named roentgenium in 2004.

Wilhelm Röntgen

Roentgenium is named in honor of the German physicist Wilhelm Conrad Röntgen, the discoverer of X-rays.



Copernicium

112 **Cn** A highly radioactive element, copernicium was first made in 1996 when atoms of zinc were made to collide with lead atoms. Some scientists think it is likely to be a gas at room temperature, but it might theoretically form bonds with other metals, such as copper and palladium.

Paying homage

Copernicium was named after the 16th-century Polish astronomer Nicolaus Copernicus, who formulated a model of the universe with the sun, rather than Earth, in the center. This is a statue of him in front of Olsztyn Castle, where he lived.